pyhydra: an open, modular Python library for reproducible hydroclimatic modelling and probabilistic flood-risk analysis

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Abstract

Flood-risk studies typically chain data acquisition, extreme-value and dependence statistics, stochastic scenario generation, climate bias correction and hydrological/hydraulic simulation through ad-hoc, difficult-to-reuse scripts, which hampers reproducibility and transfer between catchments, teams and regulatory contexts. **pyhydra** is an open, modular Python library that consolidates this chain into a single installable scientific core, organised in fifteen sub-modules: harmonised access to hydro-climatic and hydrological data from public services, extreme-value and copula-based statistics, stochastic rainfall generation, climate bias correction, hybrid statistical–dynamical downscaling, automation of HEC-HMS, HEC-RAS, SFINCS and SWAT+, and propagation of uncertainty through Monte Carlo ensembles, bootstrap and Bayesian inference, including a pilot-based rule that decides, within a fixed simulation budget, whether an expensive solver's response can be emulated or should instead be sampled by direct Monte Carlo. Individual modules can be used independently once the core package is installed via `pip` from its GitHub repository (not yet on PyPI); a companion platform, HYDRA, optionally exposes the same notebooks through a browser-based Docker deployment. pyhydra is illustrated through four flood-risk workflows at three Spanish pilot sites – Besaya, M-30 Manzanares and Valencia – spanning flu-

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vial, urban and extreme-rainfall settings; at Madrid's M-30, it re-runs the multivariate copula generation and MaxDiss selection of a published study whose 500-year design depth exceeded the classical univariate estimate by 0.83 m. pyhydra is released under the MIT license, archived on Zenodo, and its methodology already underpins six peer-reviewed journal articles from the authors' group.

Keywords: flood risk, reproducible research, hydroclimatic data harmonisation, stochastic rainfall generation, extreme value statistics, uncertainty quantification

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Required Metadata

Current code version

Nr.	Code metadata description	Metadata
C1	Current code version	v0.2.1
C2	Permanent link to code/repository used for this code version	`https://github.com/navass11/pyhydra/tree/v0.2.1`; archived at `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23342206`
C3	Legal code license	MIT License
C4	Code versioning system used	git
C5	Software code languages, tools and services used	Python ≥3.9; continuously tested on Python 3.9–3.12 (section 2.2)
C6	Compilation requirements, operating environments and dependencies	Not yet published on PyPI; install with `pip` directly from the GitHub repository in C2, optionally pinned to the tag in C1 (section 2.1). Core dependencies are declared in `pyproject.toml`; optional functionality is distributed through the `statistics`, `geospatial`, `models` and `all` extras (section 2.1). External engines (HEC-HMS, HEC-RAS, SFINCS, SWAT+) are not bundled and must be installed on the host
C7	Link to developer documentation/manual	`https://github.com/navass11/pyhydra/tree/v0.2.1` (README, `docs/` package/installation guide, and `notebooks/pilot_cases/`, which include the four illustrative examples of section 3, inspectable and executable from this repository without HYDRA, subject to the external-engine and project-data requirements listed in Table 3). The companion HYDRA platform additionally exposes the same notebooks through a browser at `https://github.com/navass11/HYDRA/tree/v0.1.2`
C8	Support email for questions	salvador.navas@alumnos.unican.es

Table 1: Code metadata (mandatory).

1. Motivation and significance

Flood-risk assessment usually requires combining several disjoint stages: acquiring precipitation, discharge, soil and climate-projection data from heterogeneous public services; fitting extreme-value and dependence models to characterise the probabilistic structure of hazard; generating or selecting a tractable set of representative scenarios; correcting the bias of climate-model output; and finally running one or more hydrological and hydraulic engines to translate scenarios into physical impacts such as water depth, velocity or inundated area. In practice this chain is implemented as one-off scripts tied to a specific study, which makes results difficult to reproduce, audit or transfer to a different catchment, team or regulatory context – a recurring obstacle in flood-risk management, where under-resourced regions are disproportionately exposed to under-characterised hazard [1].

pyhydra packages a line of methodological work on impact-based flood-risk analysis into reusable software instead of study-specific code. The approach originates in a stochastic, continuous-simulation methodology for the Besaya River at Los Corrales de Buelna (Cantabria), which combined geostatistical event generation with probabilistic regression to derive return periods directly on hydraulic impacts rather than on design hyetographs [2]. Subsequent published work extended this line to spatial stochastic rainfall fields through the companion NEOPRENE library [3], a Gaussian-copula-plus-MaxDiss pipeline for urban flood-frequency analysis in Madrid [4], climate-change impact assessment on reservoir inflows [5] and Andean hydropower systems [6], and vine-copula-based multivariate design storms [7]. Each of these studies re-implemented overlapping pieces of the same statistical and modelling machinery. pyhydra consolidates that machinery into a single, tested, versioned codebase, so that a new case study is assembled from existing building blocks – data connectors, extreme-value fitting, stochastic generators, downscaling operators and model adapters – instead of being rewritten. pyhydra does not replace the hydrological/hydraulic engines it automates (HEC-HMS [8], HEC-RAS [9], SFINCS [10], SWAT+ [11]) or the public data services it connects to [12–15]; it is the reproducible integration layer that turns their combination into an auditable, end-to-end workflow. A companion platform, HYDRA, distributes that layer with a Docker environment and browser interface for transfer to non-specialist users, without being itself part of the code metadata in table 1.

Concretely, pyhydra addresses five recurring needs from the studies above: an installable, dependency-light scientific core; a modular, reproducible architecture usable axis-by-axis; harmonised access to hydro-climatic and hydrological data; automation of hydrological/hydraulic model execution; and

propagation of uncertainty across the whole chain, from Monte Carlo ensembles to Bayesian posteriors – described in section 2 and demonstrated in sections 3 and 4. The companion HYDRA platform separately exposes this core through a web/API/Jupyter/Docker environment (section 2.1).
The contribution is therefore not a new probability distribution or physical solver. It is the software architecture that makes these existing methods composable across the complete path from source data to impact-based frequency products, while retaining the native engines as independent, replaceable components. Statistical components can be used without a hydraulic model, and model adapters can be exchanged without rewriting the climate and uncertainty layers.
The closest open frameworks cover complementary but narrower parts of this path. CLIMADA targets global climate-risk assessment through hazard, exposure and impact functions [16]; RainyDay generates stochastic storms by transposing remotely sensed fields [17]; and HydroMT with wflow automates reproducible construction and execution of distributed hydrological models from global data [18, 19]. pyhydra does not seek to replace those tools. Its distinct scope is to combine multivariate extremes, stochastic generation, climate correction, professional hydrological/hydraulic adapters and impact-based return-period analysis in one inspectable workflow. Where appropriate, it consumes ecosystem tools such as HydroMT-SFINCS as dependencies rather than duplicating them.

2. Software description

2.1. Software architecture

`pyhydra` is a pip-installable Python package with no web or infrastructure code, organised in four functional blocks – data sources, climate and statistics, model integration, and a UQ (uncertainty quantification) strategy layer – that communicate through standard data structures such as `pandas.DataFrame` for tabular series, `xarray.Dataset` for gridded data and GeoTIFF or `geopandas.GeoDataFrame` for spatial layers, so that a module in one block can be replaced or bypassed without breaking the others.
A separate, companion repository, `HYDRA`, consumes pyhydra as a dependency and adds an optional deployment layer on top of it: a JupyterLab environment, a FastAPI backend and an Astro/nginx web frontend, together with the Docker and Azure Container Apps configuration used to deploy them (fig. 1). This layer is what runs the browser-accessible illustrative examples in section 3; pyhydra itself has no dependency on it and can be used directly from any Python environment.

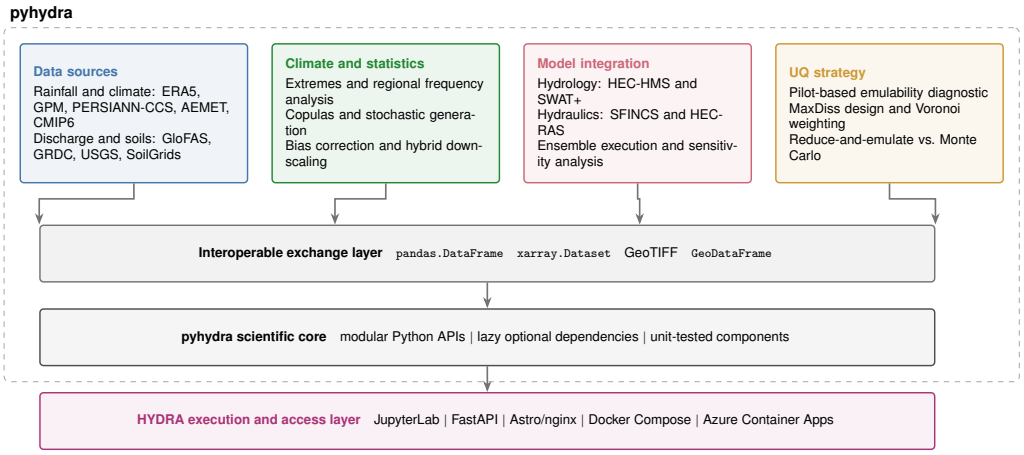


Figure 1: Software architecture. pyhydra provides four functional blocks of reusable Python components connected through standard exchange formats; HYDRA wraps the scientific core with reproducible execution, service and access layers. Colours identify functional roles and do not encode values. ChatGPT and Codex (OpenAI) assisted in writing the TikZ/Python code for this diagram; the authors independently verified the scientific content, edited the source and rendered the final figure.

Each pyhydra sub-module exposes its public API through its `__init__.py`, so the import pattern is always `from pyhydra.<block>.<module> import <name>`. OpenTURNS is a core dependency, installed by default with the core package, and provides the Gaussian-copula fitting used by `climate.spatial_analysis` (table 2) and illustrated in the M-30 example of section 3; it is imported lazily inside the specific functions that need it, following the same lazy-import convention as the optional heavy dependencies below. Optional heavy dependencies (PyMC, GDAL, GeoPandas, pyvinecopulib) are imported lazily inside the functions that need them, so the package loads – and the parts of the API that do not need them run – even when those dependencies are absent; a user who only needs extreme-value analysis or bias correction can install pyhydra with `pip` alone. Everything else is grouped into three installable extras – `statistics` (PyMC, pyvinecopulib, lmoments3), `geospatial` (GeoPandas, rasterio, pykrige, earthaccess, hydromt_sfincs) and `models` (hecdss, pySWATPlus, spotpy, NEOPRENE), plus a legacy `geo` extra for bare GDAL bindings and an `all` extra covering all four – so installing, for example, `pyhydra[statistics]` from the GitHub repository installs exactly what a given workflow needs. One extended dependency, CoSMoS_py (spatial random fields), is not yet published on PyPI and must be installed separately from its own repository. HYDRA's Docker Compose stack adds the extended scientific dependencies and orchestrates a

JupyterLab container, a FastAPI backend and an nginx-served Astro frontend, built and deployed to Azure Container Apps by a GitHub Actions workflow, with project data mounted from a persistent file share rather than baked into the images.

2.2. Software functionalities

table 2 lists the fifteen sub-modules and their main capabilities. The statistical modules implement established methodology rather than novel formulations: bias correction follows standard delta/quantile-mapping approaches [20], regional frequency analysis follows the index-flood/L-moments framework [21], and dependence modelling follows standard copula theory [22] – consistent with the framing in section 1 that the contribution is architectural, not a new statistical method.

Table 2: pyhydra modules by functional block.

Module	Block	Main capability
`data_sources.rainfall`	Data	ERA5, GPM, PERSIANN-CCS, AEMET, OGIMET, Meteostat
`data_sources.river_discharge`	Data	GloFAS, GRDC, USGS
`data_sources.climate_change`	Data	CMIP6 via CDS and ESGF
`data_sources.soils`	Data	SoilGrids download & USDA texture classification
`climate.time_series`	Climate	Event extraction, GEV/GPD fitting, NSE/KGE/PBIAS
`climate.spatial_analysis`	Climate	Regional frequency analysis, Gaussian copulas (OpenTURNS) / vine copulas (pyvinecopulib), IDW/kriging/GP interpolation
`climate.stochastic_generation`	Climate	NEOPRENE (point NSRP, spatial STNSRP), CoSMoS random fields
`climate.bias_correction`	Climate	Delta method, empirical/quantile-delta/scaled-distribution mapping
`climate.hybrid_downscaling`	Climate	Hydrograph classification, MaxDiss selection, k-NN/RBF flood-map reconstruction
`modeling.hydrology.hec_hms`	Modelling	Project generation, DSS I/O, SCE-UA calibration via spotpy
`modeling.hydrology.swat`	Modelling	SWAT+ input generation, execution, output parsing
`modeling.hydraulic.sfincs`	Modelling	Model setup, boundary conditions, batch execution
`modeling.hydraulic.hec_ras`	Modelling	1D/2D project automation, DSS result extraction
`modeling.hydraulic.sensitivity`	Modelling	Manning Monte Carlo ensembles, spatial impact regression
`uq`	UQ	Pilot-based emulability diagnostic, MaxDiss design, reduce-and-emulate vs. Monte Carlo

Abbreviations: GEV/GPD, Generalised Extreme Value / Generalised Pareto Distribution; NSE/KGE/PBIAS, Nash–Sutcliffe Efficiency / Kling–Gupta Efficiency / Percent Bias; IDW, Inverse Distance Weighting; GP, Gaussian Process; DSS, Data Storage System (HEC file format); SCE-UA, Shuffled Complex Evolution – University of Arizona; RBF, Radial Basis Function.

Four design principles guide the implementation: *modularity* (each block can be used independently – extreme-value analysis does not require geospatial or modelling dependencies); *reproducibility* (standardised notebooks, explicit parameters and data conventions preserve the evidence needed to regenerate a result, while identifying any required credentials, input projects or host-installed engines); *interoperability* (NetCDF/`xarray`, GeoTIFF, `pandas` and GeoJSON/`geopandas` as the common data currency between blocks and with external tools such as QGIS); and *operational transfer* (documentation, example notebooks and a reproducible Docker environment are treated as first-class deliverables, not optional accessories). A `pytest` suite of 297 tests in eighteen test files exercises the statistical, modelling and UQ utilities most exposed to regression. A GitHub Actions workflow (Ubuntu, core plus lightweight extended dependencies including PyMC) runs this suite on every push across a Python 3.9–3.12 matrix; the one test that depends on PyMC/pytensor is still marked `optional_dependency` and guarded to skip rather than fail if that stack is unavailable or, as happens with the older PyMC resolved on Python 3.9, incompatible with the installed NumPy. For the code version in Table 1 (commit `4a50962`, 13 October 2026), this workflow reports 297/297 passed on Python 3.10–3.12 and 296 passed plus 1 skipped on 3.9, with 32% line coverage (31% on 3.9) – concentrated in the statistical and modelling-adapter code exercised directly by unit tests, lower in the data-connector and engine-automation modules whose behaviour is instead exercised, not formally verified, by the pilot-case notebooks of section 3 against real services and engines. Runs archived at `https://github.com/navass11/pyhydra/actions/runs/38400271759`.

Reproducibility boundary. Reproducibility is reported at the level supported by each workflow. Extreme-value fitting, copula analysis and bias-correction examples are executable from included or synthetic data in the container. Public-data downloads are repeatable after the user supplies the corresponding service credentials and records the query metadata. HEC-HMS, HEC-RAS, SFINCS and SWAT+ workflows additionally require the relevant engine and a model project; large pilot cases may also contain third-party data that cannot be redistributed. fig. 2 summarises the contract. HYDRA preserves notebooks, parameters, adapters and standard outputs for these conditioned workflows, but does not claim that containerising the Python layer redistributes proprietary executables or restricted datasets.

Uncertainty propagation and analysis. Rather than being confined to a single module, uncertainty quantification cuts across the four functional blocks: asymptotic, bootstrap and Bayesian posterior estimates on extreme-

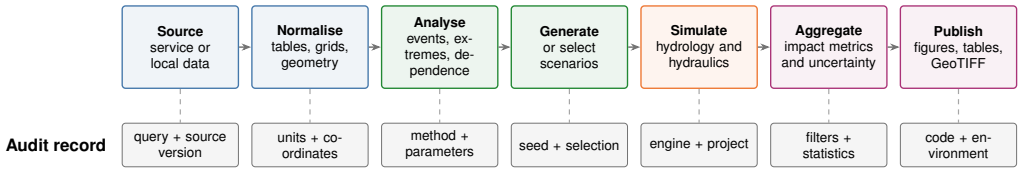


Figure 2: Reproducible workflow contract. Each transformation produces a scientific artefact and an audit record sufficient to identify its source, parameters, stochastic seed, external-engine configuration and software environment. Colours identify functional stages and do not encode values. ChatGPT and Codex (OpenAI) assisted in writing the TikZ/Python code for this diagram; the authors independently verified the scientific content, edited the source and rendered the final figure.

value parameters and return levels (`climate.time_series`); posterior propagation across pooled stations and prediction variance from spatial interpolators (`climate.spatial_analysis`); and Monte Carlo roughness ensembles aggregated into spatial impact statistics with outlier screening (`modeling.hydraulic`) – the machinery exercised by the SFINCS–HEC-RAS demonstration case in section 3. The `uq` module is a dedicated decision layer sitting above these: given an ensemble and an expensive solver, it draws a nested maximum-dissimilarity pilot charged against a fixed evaluation budget `n_max`, measures that pilot's cross-validated emulability against a declared family of cheap emulators, and from that measurement chooses between completing a reduce-and-emulate design or falling back to direct Monte Carlo – rather than fixing the choice by convention. A `StrategyDecision.margin` flags choices taken on a hair's breadth, and a companion sequential-design routine classifies each additional design point as improving, converged or deteriorating so that a flattened error curve is not mistaken for one that has turned upward.

2.3. Sample code snippets

The snippet below chains three independent pyhydra components – bias correction, stochastic rainfall generation and bivariate copula analysis – each usable on its own:

```
from pyhydra.climate.bias_correction import BiasCorrection
from pyhydra.climate.stochastic_generation.point import NSRPModel
from pyhydra.climate.spatial_analysis.copulas import BivariateCopula

# 1. Bias-correct a regional climate model precipitation series
corrected = BiasCorrection.fit_transform(
    obs, hist, future, var='pr', method='qdm')

# 2. Calibrate and simulate a Neyman-Scott rectangular-pulse
```

```
# stochastic rainfall generator (NEOPRENE; 'models' extra)
model = NSRPModel(seasonality='monthly')
model.fit(observed_series)
synthetic = model.simulate(year_ini=2000, year_fin=2100)

# 3. OR-scenario 100-year iso-return-period contour of a compound
# rainfall-discharge event
copula = BivariateCopula(family='gumbel').fit(rain_max, discharge_max)
x_or, y_or = copula.joint_return_period(t=100, kind='or')
```

3. Illustrative examples

pyhydra has been exercised through four flood-risk workflows at three Spanish pilot sites, each reproduced as a notebook sequence under `notebooks/pilot_cases/` in the pyhydra repository itself (table 1, C7); the companion HYDRA platform additionally exposes the same notebooks through a browser, without requiring the underlying pyhydra sequence to change. table 3 traces each workflow to its permanent notebook sequence and states, per the reproducibility boundary defined above, what is required to re-run it.

Los Corrales de Buelna (Besaya River, Cantabria). The founding case of the methodology [2, 24]: 42 years of continuous hydrological simulation (1970–2012) driven by 13 rain gauges, combined with geostatistical reconstruction of the rainfall series, copula-based generation of synthetic events and k-nearest-neighbour reconstruction of flood maps ($k = 6$, chosen by cross-validation) to estimate return periods directly on flood impacts rather than on design-storm discharge, in a valley-bottom town where the simulated floods may affect more than 13% of the population and 20% of the town's surface [24].

M-30 Manzanares (Madrid). Re-runs the statistical core of the multivariate flood-frequency study of Navas et al. [4] (fig. 3). In that study, 1,761 historical events from 17 rain gauges were classified by PCA + k-means. A Gaussian copula then generated approximately one million synthetic events, from which MaxDiss selected 625 representative events for HEC-HMS and steady-state HEC-RAS 1D (303 cross-sections). A k-NN regressor reconstructed depths across the synthetic ensemble under a compound Poisson frequency model. The resulting T=500-year design depth at Puente de Toledo exceeded the classical univariate-GEV estimate by 0.83 m (7.61 m vs. 6.78 m). The historical gauge events and the engine runs cannot be redistributed. The notebook sequence therefore fits pyhydra's `FloodEventCopula` to an archived 10,000-event sample of the original synthetic catalogue. The fit uses an OpenTURNS Normal copula over 84 variables, with zero-inflated marginals for dry

Table 3: Traceability of the four illustrative workflows. Notebook paths are relative to `https://github.com/navass11/pyhydra/tree/v0.2.1/notebooks/pilot_cases/`. "Yes" marks inputs that are the authors' own or openly licensed. "Partial" marks cases where some inputs are third-party records (AEMET, SIAR, AVAMET, CHC), whose reuse and redistribution follow their providers' terms of use, or are project-specific and not redistributed here.

Case	Path	Open data	External engine	Reproduction
Besaya	`los_corrales_buelna/` (9 nb.*)	Partial (authors' projects and outputs via `pyhydra-get-data`; gauge records under provider terms)	HEC-HMS, HEC-RAS	Conditioned on the engines and on the gauge records
M-30 Manzanares	`m30_manzanares/` (6 nb.)	Partial (synthetic-catalogue sample, archived results)	None (engine results archived)	Copula generation and MaxDiss re-run with pyhydra; design depths read from archived engine results
Valencia DANA	`valencia_dana/` (3 nb.†)	Partial (AEMET, SIAR and AVAMET records under provider terms, via `pyhydra-get-data`)	None	Reproducible for the single-station and pooled-regional analyses with those records
SFINCS–HEC-RAS	`manning_rugosidades/` (7 nb.)	Yes (Zenodo dataset [23])	SFINCS, HEC-RAS	Ensemble aggregation re-runs from the archived 2×1,000 outputs; re-simulation needs the engines

*Steps 01–08 form the impact-frequency workflow; step 09 applies the `uq` decision layer to its MaxDiss design. †Steps 01–02 produce the results reported here; step 03 extends the regional analysis with a hierarchical Bayesian GEV (PyMC) on project data not distributed through `pyhydra-get-data`.

gauges. It regenerates 100,000 events that reproduce the sample's dry-gauge shares and its full rank-dependence structure (mean $|\Delta\rho| = 0.011$ over 3,486 variable pairs). It then selects 625 events with pyhydra's MaxDiss in the full 84-dimensional space. The published design depths are read from the archived study outputs, not recomputed.

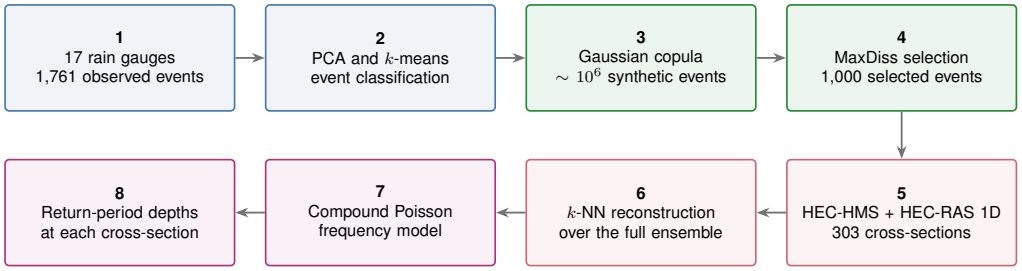


Figure 3: End-to-end pipeline of the M-30 Manzanares study [4]: from 17 rain-gauge series (step 1) to return-period depths at two control cross-sections, Puente de Toledo and Represa nº9 (step 8). The pilot notebooks re-run copula generation and MaxDiss selection with pyhydra; simulation, emulation and frequency outputs are taken from the archived study results. Blue denotes observations and event classification, green statistical generation and selection, orange physical simulation and emulation, and purple frequency outputs. ChatGPT and Codex (OpenAI) assisted in writing the TikZ/Python code for this diagram; the authors independently verified the scientific content, edited the source and rendered the final figure.

Valencia DANA (October 2024). Implements an extreme-value fitting comparison for the record-breaking rainfall event that struck the Comunitat Valenciana on 29 October 2024, when AEMET's official post-event report [25] recorded new national single-station intensity records at Turís (station 8337X); the dataset used here, aggregated on calendar days, gives 710.8 mm/24h at that station. Two notebooks, downloadable in full with `pyhydra-get-data valencia_dana` and requiring no AEMET credentials at run time, fit GEV distributions at Turís with and without the event: single-station fits by three methods (MLE, L-moments, Bayesian/MCMC), and a pooled-regional fit (index-flood standardisation over all nine stations) by MLE and L-moments. Including the event raises the estimated T=100-year return level by a factor of 3.5–4.6 depending on method and scale, from 218–271 mm to 756–1,241 mm (fig. 4).

SFINCS–HEC-RAS uncertainty comparison (Besaya River). A fourth demonstration case exercises the uncertainty-propagation machinery of section 2.2 across two independent 2D hydraulic engines: `generate_manning_combinations` draws 1,000 Monte Carlo roughness realisations over nine land-use classes from literature distribu-

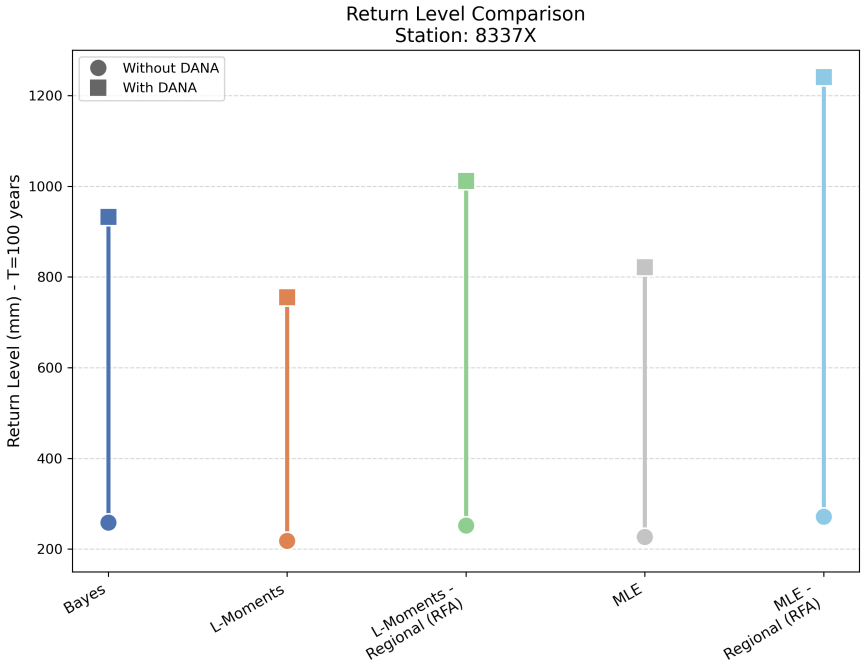


Figure 4: T=100-year return-level estimates at station 8337X (Turís), with and without the 29 October 2024 event, for the single-station (MLE, L-moments, Bayesian/MCMC) and pooled-regional-RFA (MLE, L-moments) fits reproduced by the two archived notebooks described in the text.

tions, the same ensemble is run through both SFINCS and HEC-RAS, and `load_sfincs_ensemble`/`load_flood_ensemble` together with `spatial_stats` and `manning_flood_regression` aggregate each engine's inundation output into comparable spatial impact statistics (fig. 5). This section presents only the pyhydra ensemble-generation and aggregation workflow, on one engine, as a software demonstration; the resulting two-engine scientific comparison between SFINCS and HEC-RAS is out of scope here and reported separately. Model configurations (including terrain and mesh), the 1,000 SFINCS and 1,000 HEC-RAS outputs and the derived tables are archived openly on Zenodo [23].

The four workflows follow complementary execution paths – continuous impact-frequency analysis with hydraulic ensembles (Besaya), rainfall, runoff and hydraulic modelling (M-30), statistical inference without an external solver (Valencia), and Monte Carlo roughness ensembles on two hydraulic engines (SFINCS–HEC-RAS) – and are not the only published applications of the underlying methodology: the same building blocks also support published work on Andean hydropower systems [6] and reservoir inflows under

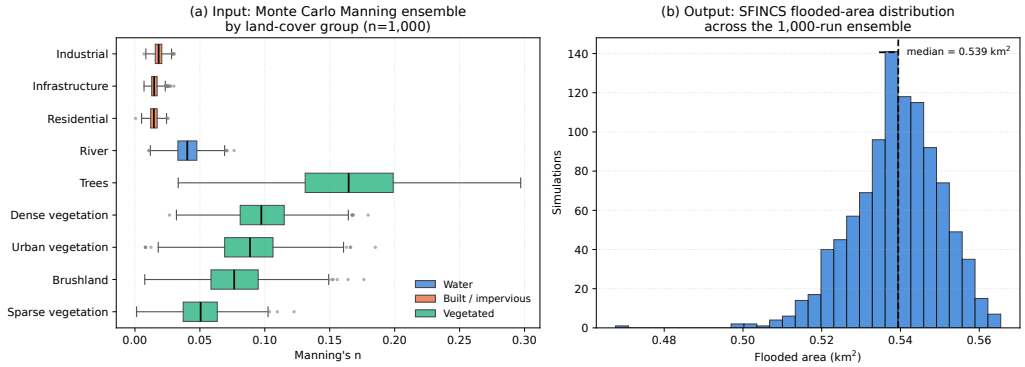


Figure 5: (a) Input ensemble generated by pyhydra's `generate_manning_combinations`: 1,000 Manning-roughness combinations over nine land-use classes, grouped by land-cover type (water, built/impervious, vegetated; boxes: interquartile range; line: median; whiskers: non-outlier range; dots: outliers). (b) Output: flooded-area distribution across the same 1,000-run SFINCS ensemble, computed from the archived simulation outputs with pyhydra's `load_flood_ensemble` and `flooded_area`. This single-engine distribution documents the ensemble-aggregation workflow only; the two-engine SFINCS/HEC-RAS inundation comparison is out of scope here and reported separately.

climate change [5].

4. Impact

pyhydra formalises, as versioned and tested software, a line of flood-risk research that previously existed as independent, non-interoperable study codebases. Six published journal articles, produced by the authors' group, already rely on methods now consolidated in pyhydra [2–7]. Conference proceedings and manuscripts still under review are not counted here as impact evidence. This methodological track record predates pyhydra as a software product and shows that the underlying methods work; it is distinct from, and does not substitute for, evidence that the software itself has been adopted outside the authors' group.

Beyond consolidating methods that already existed as separate scripts, having them share a common ensemble and impact-statistics layer (section 2.2) also opens questions that were impractical to pose across four disconnected codebases: how differently two hydraulic engines propagate the same roughness ensemble into inundation extent, for which section 3 demonstrates the ensemble-generation and aggregation workflow and the comparison itself is reported separately; and how directly conditioning frequency analysis on spatial impacts, rather than on discharge or rainfall alone, shifts design estimates relative to the classical univariate route, as the published M-30 study quantifies (section 3).

As a software product, pyhydra's impact so far is internal to the authors' group, reported as such rather than overstated. A new case study is now assembled from existing, unit-tested building blocks rather than rewritten – what let the four workflows of section 3 share one code base instead of four disconnected scripts. Applying the generic copula fitter to the real M-30 catalogue also exposed and fixed a defect that study-specific scripts would have hidden: with the default all-family search, heavy-tailed marginals were selected for zero-inflated gauge rainfall. Restricted families and zero-inflated marginals are now part of the tested API. Archiving pyhydra under the MIT license on Zenodo [26] gives each downstream publication a citable, versioned code reference, closing a gap that affected the earlier, unpublished study scripts. The companion HYDRA platform (section 2.1), archived separately [27] and reachable, as of 30 July 2026, at the URL given in its README[1], removes local-environment setup as a barrier to inspecting any of the four notebooks with the full scientific stack pre-installed.

Because the public GitHub release is recent, independent adoption metrics – downloads, external contributions, third-party citations, teaching or com-

[1]Ephemeral Azure Container Apps deployment; useful for evaluation but not a citable scholarly reference. The Zenodo records remain the durable citation for both components.

mercial use – are not yet available, and none are claimed here. pyhydra is used in ongoing doctoral and project research at IHCantabria – Universidad de Cantabria; broadening use beyond the authors' group is future work (section 5).

5. Conclusions

pyhydra turns a multi-year line of impact-based flood-risk research into modular, tested, MIT-licensed software: an installable scientific core with a modular, reproducible architecture; harmonised access to hydro-climatic and hydrological data; automation of hydrological and hydraulic models; and propagation and analysis of uncertainty across the whole chain. The companion HYDRA platform separately provides an optional operational web, API, Jupyter and Docker environment on top of this core, without changing how pyhydra itself is installed or used. Four workflows at three Spanish pilot sites – Besaya, M-30 Manzanares and Valencia – span fluvial, urban and extreme-rainfall flood risk. Together they show that the same modular components support markedly different study designs, from continuous stochastic simulation to multivariate copula-based frequency analysis and Monte Carlo ensembles run through two hydraulic engines. Ongoing work focuses on widening automated test coverage as new modules are added, adding adapters for further hydraulic/hydrological engines, and documenting a stable public API to lower the barrier for external contributions beyond the authors' own research group.

The present release also has explicit limits. Short records and rare extremes remain information-limited even under bootstrap, Bayesian or regional uncertainty quantification, and regional analysis still requires a defensible homogeneous region; stochastic generators do not by themselves resolve climate non-stationarity; emulators and MaxDiss selection reduce hydraulic-ensemble cost but cannot replace physical-model validation, and depend on the representativeness of the simulated subset; and reproducibility of externally executed models is conditioned by engine version, licences and project availability. HYDRA makes these dependencies explicit and auditable rather than removing them.

CRediT authorship contribution statement

Salvador Navas: Conceptualization, Methodology, Software, Data curation, Formal analysis, Investigation, Validation, Visualization, Writing – original draft, Writing – review & editing. **Manuel del Jesus:** Conceptualization, Methodology, Resources, Supervision, Funding acquisition, Validation, Writing – review & editing.

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Declaration of competing interests

The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

Data availability

The pyhydra version described in this article is available through the versioned GitHub and Zenodo records in Table 1. The companion HYDRA deployment platform used to run the browser-accessible workflows in section 3 is likewise open source and MIT-licensed, and is archived separately [27]. The authors' own models and inputs for the Besaya, Valencia and SFINCS–HEC-RAS pilot cases, and the synthetic-event sample and archived results of the M-30 case, are downloadable with `pyhydra-get-data`. The SFINCS–HEC-RAS model configurations, simulation outputs, tables and scripts are additionally archived on Zenodo under CC-BY-4.0 [23]. The 1,761 historical M-30 gauge events are third-party data and are not redistributed, and the hydrological and hydraulic engines (HEC-HMS, HEC-RAS, SFINCS, SWAT+) must be obtained from their developers. The Besaya and Valencia inputs include gauge records from AEMET and the Confederación Hidrográfica del Cantábrico (Besaya) and from AEMET, SIAR and AVAMET (Valencia). These third-party records are not offered here as open data: their reuse and redistribution remain governed by the providers' terms of use. The pilot workflows also consume the public data services cited in the text.

Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies in the manuscript preparation process

During manuscript preparation (2026), the authors used ChatGPT and the Codex coding assistant (OpenAI; specific model versions not recorded)

to assist with language editing, text revision, manuscript formatting and the drafting of figure code (identified in the affected captions); during these revisions (30 July – 4 August 2026), Claude Sonnet 5 (model ID `claude-sonnet-5`, Anthropic) assisted with editing manuscript text, diagnosing and fixing software defects surfaced by the continuous-integration workflow added in section 2.2, and re-executing the Valencia notebooks to regenerate fig. 4 from their output. During later revisions (14 September – 13 October 2026), Claude Sonnet 5 (`claude-sonnet-5`) and Claude Opus 5.5 (`claude-opus-5-5`), both from Anthropic, assisted with auditing the manuscript against the repositories and pilot notebooks, editing manuscript text, fixing LaTeX defects, implementing the restricted-family and zero-inflated marginal options of `FloodEventCopula` with their unit tests, and rewriting and re-executing M-30 notebooks 03–06. In a final pre-submission review (13–14 October 2026), Claude Sonnet 5.5 (`claude-sonnet-5-5`, Anthropic) assisted with checking the manuscript's figures and citations against the notebooks, the cited sources and Crossref, correcting text, bibliography and figure-export defects, compiling the manuscript, carrying out the v0.2.1 release steps and removing a stray submodule entry from the pyhydra repository. In all cases, assistance was limited to code and text; it did not extend to designing the underlying methodology or validating its scientific content. After using these tools, the authors reviewed and edited the content and code as needed, checked the cited evidence and numerical values, and take full responsibility for the content of the published article and the archived code.

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Current executable software version

pyhydra v0.2.1 (commit `4a50962`) is the executable software version described in this publication; its archived record and immutable GitHub tag link are provided in Table 1 and should be cited independently using the corresponding Zenodo record [26]. The companion HYDRA deployment platform used for the browser-accessible examples in section 3 is archived separately at v0.1.2 (commit `627a838`) [27].